

Cole Arthur Riley: The Silence of God

Reflect

- Has there been a time in your life when you felt God was silent? If so, describe what that experience was like.
- Cole opens her talk by asking, "How can we retain belief in a silent God?" How would you answer that question?
- Cole talks about the way in which skepticism was helpful in her own faith journey. Have your questions, doubts, or skepticism been affirmed by faith communities? How have these things been helpful in your own spiritual formation?

Respond

- The church has often interpreted the silence of God as a form of punishment or as an indication of divine absence. In what ways might God's silence be understood as an expression of love or compassion?
- Do you intentionally pursue periods of silence in your own life? If so, how do they nurture you personally and spiritually?